

MS Will Require Authentication Of Windows

Starting the second half of this year, users will have to authenticate their copies of Windows before being able to download updates etc. from the Microsoft Download Centre or Windows Update, the company said in a recent press release.



Sony Ericsson To Launch Walkman Phone

Sony Ericsson will soon cash in on the 'Walkman' brand. The Walkman phone, due to be launched in March, will have sufficient storage for six to ten CDs' worth of songs encoded in MP3 or AAC format. Tracks will be copy-protected using DRM 2.0.



Enter

Adnan Sami
Musician

An accomplished concert pianist, singer and composer, Adnan Sami is often called the 'fastest keyboard player in the world'. A tech-savvy musician, he does not hesitate to try new gizmos.

How do you use technology on a daily basis?

I e-mail often and browse the Internet to read about the latest in technology, software and music.

What gadgets do you use?

I keep upgrading my hardware and software. I have an Apple G5, digital and DV cameras (Sony), a 56-inch GVC Plasma display TV, BMW home theatre systems and Onkyo amps at home. In the studio, I use a Compaq laptop, Yamaha mixers, Tascam tape recorders and CD burners.

How does technology help you create music?

My music production is entirely digital-based. I work in London and Mumbai studios, use numerous music creation, editing and sound-related software. I use several synthesizers including Roland Fantom and Yamaha Motif.

How do you keep update yourself about news and technology trends?

I surf music and software related sites and read *The New York Times* and *Variety*. However, 'information overload' makes it difficult for me to sift the genuine news from the trivial.

AN INDIAN RAINBOW

Made In India: The Handheld Of Tomorrow

It looks like a PDA; it weighs as much as and feels like one. But functionally, it is more like a laptop computer and a mobile phone shrunk into the body of a pocket PC. And it has been developed by Indian engineers at iWave Systems Technologies, an up-and-coming embedded products firm based in Bangalore.

The 'Rainbow' handheld mobility platform is one of the first devices in the world to exploit the power of a new chip, the Bulverde. The Bulverde was launched by Intel just four months ago to fuel tomorrow's 'convergence' products.

The Rainbow has multiple wireless Internet options: GSM/GPRS via the mobile phone, WiFi, infrared and Bluetooth.

It is also one of the first handhelds to exploit the Linux OS. There is 128 megabytes of on-board memory and a gigabyte of expandable disk space.

The full-function keyboard is larger than what most handheld PCs provide, while the display is a 10-cm diagonal screen, which doubles up as a touch-sensitive panel. A camera is integrated. However, it is the Bulverde that gives the Rainbow its real strength—for instance, it also has the ability to send and receive DVD-quality digital still and video pictures.



iWave first demonstrated the Rainbow a few weeks ago at the Embedded Technology Conference in Yokohama, Japan. The company's engineers expect that the end price would be somewhere between that of a high-end phone and a laptop, which should make it around Rs 30,000 in India.

THE ALIANCE WILL WORK WELL FOR BOTH

NIIT Ties Up With SAP

NIIT Technologies has entered into an alliance with SAP, the world's largest enterprise

applications software provider. The NIIT-SAP alliance will focus on implementing projects in the Government and Public sectors.

Arvind Thakur, CEO, NIIT Technologies spoke about the significance of the tie-up. "India is the fastest growing IT market in the Asia-Pacific region. Our strong competence in providing solutions around the SAP solution suite and proven track record in enabling government bodies to be more effective and efficient, will enable both organisations to grow," said Thakur.

Alan Sedghi, President and MD (Indian Subcontinent), SAP, added, "Governments in India are increasingly taking